avoidance of war. A careful scrutiny of the record demonstrates that this argument is not entirely satisfactory. In the immediate aftermath of the attack on the Indian parliament on December 13, 2001, the United States acted with considerable alacrity to fend off any precipitate Indian actions against Pakistan.[82] A combination of American pressure and the unavailability of viable conventional strike options against Pakistan at short notice inhibited India from undertaking a quick attack against either Pakistan territory or Pakistan-controlled Kashmir. Nevertheless, India embarked on a process of general mobilization of its forces with the explicit goal of preparing for a major conventional confrontation with Pakistan. As India geared up its forces for a possible war, the United States exerted pressure on Pakistan to rein in the jihadi forces and continued to urge India to exercise restraint.[83] U.S. efforts appeared to produce the appropriate response from General Musharraf when he gave a speech on January 12 in which he explicitly stated that "Pakistan will not allow its territory to be used for any terrorist activity anywhere in the world."[84] In the aftermath of this speech, India was placed in an awkward position. It could ill afford to lash out militarily before Pakistan had the opportunity to move against the jihadi organizations. In the aftermath of General Musharraf's speech, it appeared that he would make a serious attempt to dismantle the jihadi infrastructure.[85] Within a week of that speech, the U.S. secretary of state Colin Powell publicly praised Pakistan's attempts to crack down on Islamist militants.[86]

Over the next several months, militancy in Kashmir did decline. Such a decline, however, was also seasonal. During the winter months, given the state of mountain passes, infiltration normally declines. Despite the lack of militant activity, Indian forces remained on alert in pursuit of a strategy of "coercive diplomacy" designed to sustain pressure on Pakistan to end its support for insurgency and terrorism.[87]

This lull in terrorist activity would prove to be temporary. On May 14, 2002, a group of terrorists struck an Indian army base in Kaluchak outside Srinagar in Indian-controlled Kashmir killing some thirty people including ten children of military personnel.[88] Anger against Pakistan, which had subsided somewhat, once again came